IRHE SOHN

Department of East Asian Languages and Cultures
Smith College

DEGREES

PhD in Asian Languages and Cultures — 2018
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor
Dissertation: "Enterprises of the Feeble: The Makings of Cinema in Colonial Korea"

MA in Cinema Studies — 2005
Korea National University of Arts

BS in Mathematical Science — 2003
Seoul National University

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Smith College — 2018–Present
Assistant Professor
Department of East Asian Languages and Cultures

Seoul National University — 2025–Present
Visiting Professor
International Summer Program

GRANT RECEIVED

Korean Studies Grant — 2022
Academy of Korean Studies

Jean Picker Fellowship — Fall 2020
Smith College

Korea Research Travel Grant — 2020
Northeast Asia Council, Association for Asian Studies

Dissertation Fellowship — 2017–2018
Academy of Korean Studies

Hide Shohara Fellowship 2017
University of Michigan

Japan Studies Fellowship 2015–2016
Japan-Korea Cultural Foundation

Seah-Haiam Arts and Science Fellowship 2011–2013
Nam Center for Korean Studies, University of Michigan

Korea Foundation Graduate Fellowship 2011–2012
Korea Foundation

PUBLICATIONS

Books

Promises of Failure: Dreams of Cinema in Colonial Korea (forthcoming from Rutgers University Press)

Articles and Book Chapters

"Cinema, the Demand of Our People: The Politics of Address in Early Cinema of Colonial Korea," Ungsan Kim and Sangjoon Lee eds., *The Oxford Handbook of Korean Cinema* (under review)

"Writing Boys and Uppity Girls: Gendered Subjectivities of Children in Late-colonial Korean Cinema" [글 쓰는 소년과 시건방진 소녀: 식민지 말기 조선영화 소국민 서사의 젠더화], *Asian Cinema Studies* [아시아영화연구] 15.3 (December 2022): 7–36. (Peer-reviewed; written and published in Korean)

"Field of Revision: Adaptations of *Wren's Elegy* by Mo Yunsuk and Kim Kiyoung" (Co-authored by Ki-in Chong), *Adaptation* 15.1 (March 2022): 100–112. (Peer-reviewed)

"Imperial Ethos, Colonial Pathos: Affective Realism of Colonial Korean Cinema" [帝國思潮、殖民悲情：殖民時期韓國電影的情感寫實主義] in *Tracing the Footsteps of Motion Pictures: An Anthology of Early Taiwanese and East Asian Cinemas* [動態影像的足跡—早期臺灣與東亞電影史], edited by Daw-Ming Lee. Taipei: Taiwan National University of the Arts, 2019. (Invited, peer-reviewed; written in English and translated into Chinese by Mei-Hsuan Chiang)

"Peripheral Visions of Yusin: Techniscope Action Cinema and the Anxiety of the State." In *Cultures of Yusin: South Korea in the 1970s*, edited by Youngju Ryu. Ann Arbor: University of Michigan Press, 2018. (Invited, peer-reviewed)

"A Coming Korean Cinema and Its Singularity: Rethinking Im Hwa's *Treatises on Korean Cinema*" [도래해야 하는 식민지 조선영화의 고유성: 임화의 조선영화론 재고]. In *Conversations of East Asian Intellectuals* [동아시아 지식인의 대화], edited by Soyoung Kim. Seoul: Hyŏnsil Munhwa, 2018. (Invited, peer-reviewed; written and published in Korean)

"*Im Hwa's Cinema* vs. Im Hwa's Cinema" [<임화의 영화> 대 임화의 영화]. *Sai* 18 (Fall 2015): 249–276. (Peer-reviewed; written and published in Korean)

"Play, Pause: Female Representation in Narrative Cinema of Colonial Korea" [재생, 일시정지: 식민지 조선의 서사영화와 여성 재현의 정치학]. *Journal of Popular Narratives* [대중서사연구] 18 (Winter 2007): 289–323. (Peer-reviewed; written and published in Korean)

Introductions to Books

"Colonial Korean Cinema and Architecture: Introduction to *Korea and Architecture*" [건축의 관점에서 본 조선영화: <朝鮮と建築> 해제] in *Sourcebook Series: Colonial Korean Cinema in Japanese Magazines* [일본어 잡지로 본 조선영화]. Vol. 8. Seoul: Korea Film Archive, 2018. (Written and published in Korean)

"Manchuria as an Archive of Trans/national Cinema" [트랜스/내셔널 시네마적 상상력의 아카이브로서 만주] in *Sourcebook Series: Colonial Korean Cinema in Japanese Magazines* [일본어 잡지로 본 조선영화]. Vol. 7. Seoul: Korea Film Archive, 2016. (Written and published in Korean)

Book Reviews

Review of Cold War Cosmopolitanism: Period Style in 1950s Korean Cinema by Christina Klein, *Journal of Japanese and Korean Cinema* 12.2 (2020): 163–166.

Review of *Korean Horror Cinema*. H-Asia, H-Net Reviews (2015). http://www.h-net.org/reviews/showrev.php?id=42771

Translations

Sourcebook Series: Colonial Korean Cinema in Japanese Magazines [일본어 잡지로 본 조선영화]. Vol. 8. Seoul: Korea Film Archive, 2018.

- Japanese to Korean: Translation of historical resources for Korean film history

Sourcebook Series: Colonial Korean Cinema in Japanese Magazines [일본어 잡지로 본 조선영화]. Vol. 7. Seoul: Korea Film Archive, 2016.

- Japanese to Korean: Translation of historical resources for Korean film history

The Japan Proletarian Film League DVD [プロキノ作品集]. Tōkyō: Rikka Press.

- Japanese to English: Translation of subtitles & intertitles of Japanese leftist films in the 1920s and 1930s

SCHOLARLY LECTURES AND PRESENTATIONS

Invited Lectures

James Joo-Jin Kim Center for Korean Studies April 9, 2026
University of Pennsylvania

- "Promises of Failure: Dreams of Cinema in Colonial Korea"

The Kyujanggak International Symposium on Korean Studies Nov. 8, 2024
Seoul National University

- "The Golden Age of Embitterment: The Politics of Emotion of Korean Cinema in the Late 1920s"

Crossing Boundaries: Literature, Cinema, and New Media in Korea April 7, 2023
Indiana University

- "Women Filmmakers from the Ruins of the Golden Age: On Hong Eun-won's *A Woman Judge* (1962)"

Golden Age of Cinema in Postwar South Korea: Film Symposium Feb. 5, 2023
GYOPO and UCLA Center for Korean Studies

- "Rethinking the Golden Age with *A Female Judge* (1962) and *Hommage* (2022)"

Korean Studies Colloquium Series April 8, 2022
New York University

- "Sacred Translations: *Parasite*, English Subtitles, and Global Korean Cinema"

Nam Center for Korean Studies Colloquium Series Jan. 26, 2021
University of Michigan Ann Arbor

- "Sacred Translations: *Parasite*, English Subtitles, and Korean National Cinema"

Center for East Asian Studies Colloquium Series Sept. 25, 2019
Yale University

- "Of the Children, by the Children, but for the Adults: Promoting Colonial Korean Films in Japan, 1940–1941"

Korea Film Archive July 12, 2019

- "Promises of Failure: Ways of Looking at Colonial Korean Cinema"

University of Tokyo April 28, 2016
The 20th Global Japan Studies Seminar, Institute for Advanced Studies on Asia

- "Imperial Ethos, Colonial Pathos: Affective Realism and the Limits of the Transcolonial Film Coproduction"

Papers Presented

The Association for Asian Studies Annual Conference March 2026
Vancouver, BC, Canada

- "Documenting Korea (Post)colonially: O yŏng-jin's Film Realism and the Question of Decolonization"

Society for Cinema and Media Studies Annual Conference April 2025
Chicago, IL

- "The Golden Age of Embitterment: The Politics of Emotion of Korean Cinema in the Late 1920s."

The Association for Asian Studies Annual Conference March 2023
Boston, MA

- "Revising the 'Authentic' Narrative: On the Adaptation of *Pachinko*."

The Association for Asian Studies Annual Conference March 2022
Honolulu, HI

- "Disappearing into Darkness: *The Underground Village* (1931) and Leftist Filmmaking in Colonial Korea."

The Association for Asian Studies Annual Conference March 2021
Virtual

- "Loving Subtitles: Translation of *Parasite* (2019) and the Articulation of Global Korean Cinema."

The Association for Asian Studies Annual Conference March 2019
Denver, CO

- "Struggles of Wren and Simon: *Wren's Elegy* at the Crossroad between Poetry and Cinema." [Co-presented by Ki-in Chong]

Society for Cinema and Media Studies Annual Conference March 2018
Toronto, ON

- "A Physiology of the Feeble: Im Hwa's Vision for Colonial Korean Cinema."

The Association for Asian Studies Annual Conference March 2017
Toronto, ON

- "From the Empire for Children to a World without Children: Ch'oe Ingyu's Films Before and After Liberation."

The International Conference on the Film Histories of Taiwan and Asia October 2016
Taipei National University of the Arts, Taipei, Taiwan

- "Imperial Ethos, Colonial Pathos: Affective Realism of Colonial Cinema"

The Im Hwa Literature Symposium October 2015

Musashi University, Tokyo, Japan
- "A Coming Korean Cinema and Its Singularity: Rethinking Im Hwa's Treatises on Korean Cinema."

The Perspectives on Contemporary Korea Conference Nov. 2014
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI
- "Half-Sized Action Movies and Peripheral Visions of Yushin."

The Association for Asian Studies Annual Conference March 2014
Philadelphia, PA
- "*Shokumin* or *Singmin*: Communist Mapping of Colonial Cinema and Colonial Realities of Korean Cinema."

The Permanent Seminar on Histories of Film Theories Sept. 2012
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI
- "A Condition of Theory: Im Hwa and Im/possibility of Film Theory in Colonial Korea."

COURSES TAUGHT

Smith College (2018–present)
Korean Cinema: Cinema and the Masses
Women and Narration in Modern Korea
Audiovisual Translation of Korean Media
Democracies in Korean Film and Media
Special Studies: Translating Korean Poetry
Special Studies: Japanese Documentary Film
Special Studies: Korean Science Fiction

Seoul National University International Summer School (2025–present)
Stars in East Asian Film and Media

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Association for Asian Studies
Society for Cinema and Media Studies